VISVESVARAYA TECHNOLOGICAL UNIVERSITY

Belagavi-590018

A Mini Project Report On

"LOST AND FOUND PLATFORM"

In

Computer Science and Engineering

By

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Mini Project entitled **"Lost and Found Platform"** has been successfully completed by **Shubda(1AJ23CS147), Sindhu(1AJ23CS152), Sushmitha(1AJ23CS164), Vijayalaxmi(1AJ23CS181)** the students of **Department of Computer Science & Engineering, Cambridge Institute of Technology North Campus** of the **Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi,** during the year 2025–2026. It is certified that all corrections or suggestions indicated for Internal Assessment have been incorporated in the report deposited in the departmental library. The Mini Project Report has been approved as it satisfies the academic requirements in respect of Mini Project work prescribed for the Bachelor of Engineering Degree.

Project Guide

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External Viva:

Name of the Examiners and Signature with Date

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Declaration

We, **Shubda, Sindhu, Sushmitha, Vijayalaxmi** hereby declare that the dissertation entitled, **"LOST and FOUND PLATFORM"** is completed and written by us under the supervision of my guide **Prof. P Gopala Krishna, Assistant Professor, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Cambridge Institute of Technology North Campus, Kundana, Bengaluru,** of the **Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi,** during the academic year 2025- 2026. The dissertation report is original and it has not been submitted for any other degree in any university.

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CHAPTER-1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 MINI PROJECT DESCRIPTION

The Lost and Found Platform is developed as a smart digital solution that modernizes how institutions handle misplaced belongings. Instead of relying on physical registers or manual communication, the system provides a structured online environment where users can instantly report items they have lost or submit items they have found. Each entry can include detailed descriptions, categories, timestamps, and uploaded images, making it easy to identify and verify belongings. The platform also incorporates automated matching logic that compares keywords,

item categories, and images to suggest potential matches between lost and found reports, thereby improving the chances of quick recovery. The system maintains an organized database that allows both users and administrators to search, filter, and track items with ease, ensuring that no information is overlooked or misplaced. Administrators have access to a secure dashboard where they can validate submissions, mark items as claimed, resolve conflicts, and maintain overall system integrity. In addition, the platform features user authentication, real-time status updates,

and proper verification steps to ensure that items are handed back to the rightful owners. By combining automation with a user-friendly interface, the project significantly minimizes confusion, reduces human errors, and ensures that information remains accessible at all times. Overall, the Lost and Found Platform enhances transparency, strengthens accountability, and promotes an organized method of item management, making it an essential digital tool for campuses, offices, malls, and other public institutions.

Key Points

1. Core Functional Features

- Allows users to report lost items with descriptions, categories, and images.
- Enables users to submit information about items they have found.
- Provides search and filter options to locate items quickly.
- Uses automated matching to compare lost and found entries.
- Displays real-time status updates (Lost, Found, Verified, Claimed).
- Includes image uploads for better identification and verification.

2. User-Related Features

- User-friendly interface designed for easy navigation.
- Secure login system for reporting and claiming items.
- Notification or alert messages when a matching item is found.
- History log for previously reported or claimed items.

3. Admin Features

- Admin dashboard for managing and verifying submissions.
- Ability to approve, reject, or mark items as resolved.
- Ensures proper verification before handing over an item.
- Maintains the integrity and accuracy of the item database.

4. System Benefits

- Reduces manual paperwork and eliminates physical registers.
- Minimizes human error through automation and digital records.
- Speeds up item retrieval and improves overall efficiency.

5. Technical Strengths

- Built using modern web technologies (Flask / PHP / Node.js, HTML, CSS).
- Centralized database for storing all lost and found records securely.
- Scalable design suitable for campuses, offices, malls, and public places.

1.2 INTRODUCTION TO LOST & FOUND SYSTEMS

Lost and Found systems play a vital role in maintaining order and ensuring proper item management in environments where people continuously move, interact, and carry personal belongings. These environments include schools, colleges, offices, transportation hubs, malls, libraries, hostels, and other public spaces where the chances of misplacing valuable items are naturally high. A well-structured Lost and Found system ensures that belongings such as mobile phones, ID cards, wallets, books, accessories, and documents are not permanently lost but can be recovered by their rightful owners through a systematic process. Traditionally, these systems were operated through handwritten registers, verbal communication, or simple notes, which often resulted in errors, incomplete information, and misplaced records. Such manual methods also made it difficult to track an item's journey from being found to being returned, especially in large institutions where hundreds of users interact daily . As the scale of operations in modern institutions has expanded, the number of lost items has grown significantly, causing traditional systems to become inefficient and unreliable. Institutions today require a solution that is not only organized but also capable of handling large volumes of data quickly and accurately. To overcome these limitations, organizations are increasingly adopting digital Lost and Found platforms that bring structure, automation, and transparency to the entire process. These digital systems allow users or staff to document lost and found items using detailed descriptions, category tags, timestamps, and supporting images, which greatly enhances item identification. Features such as automated matching algorithms, keyword search, filtering options, and instant notifications make the retrieval process much easier and faster for users.

Key Points

1. Purpose of Lost & Found Systems

- Designed to help users recover misplaced items in an organized manner.
- Ensures that found items are properly recorded, stored, and returned to their rightful owners.
- Provides a formal mechanism for tracking items in busy environments.

2. Limitations of Traditional Systems

- Manual registers often lead to incomplete or inaccurate entries.
- Increased chances of miscommunication and human error.
- Time-consuming for both users and administrators.
- Difficult to search or retrieve past records when needed.

3. Need for Modern Digital Systems

- Rising number of lost items in large institutions requires more efficient methods.
- Digital systems ensure faster reporting, searching, and recovery.
- Provide better accuracy and transparency compared to manual logs.
- Reduce paperwork and centralize all information in one place.

4. Features of Digital Lost & Found Systems

- Allow submission of item details with images, categories, and timestamps.
- Offer quick search and filtering options to match lost and found items.
- Support automated notifications to alert users about potential matches.
- Maintain a secure, organized database that is easy to manage and update.

5. Benefits to Institutions and Users

- Saves time by reducing manual verification and repeated inquiries.
- Enhances user experience with clear communication and real-time updates.
- Builds trust through transparent item management and proper documentation.
- Improves operational efficiency for administrators handling large item volumes.

6. Security & Accountability in Lost & Found Systems

- Modern systems ensure that every item entry is time-stamped and linked to a verified user or administrator.
- This reduces the chances of false claims, unauthorized access, or tampering with records.
- Logged activities help track who added, updated, or collected any item, increasing accountability.

1.3 INTRODUCTION TO WEB TECHNOLOGIES (Flask)

Flask is highly preferred in modern web development because it provides developers with complete control over the application's architecture without forcing unnecessary components. Its microframework nature means that developers only import the features they truly need, resulting in clean, optimized, and easily understandable code. This simplicity also makes Flask an excellent choice for beginners who are learning how web applications work internally, as well as for professionals building production-ready platforms.

Another major advantage of Flask is its strong support for customization. Developers can integrate third-party libraries such as Flask-Login for user authentication, Flask-Mail for email notifications, Flask-Migrate for database migrations, and Flask-CORS for cross-domain communication. This modularity enables Flask applications to grow from simple prototypes to complex, scalable systems without rewriting the entire codebase. Flask also supports asynchronous request handling and can be combined with technologies like WebSocket's for real-time features such as instant notifications, live updates, and chat components.

Flask's development environment is highly developer-friendly, offering features such as a built-in debugger, error tracking, and an interactive development server. These tools help identify issues quickly and streamline the testing process. Flask applications can be deployed easily on cloud platforms like AWS, Google Cloud, Render, Heroku, and PythonAnywhere, making it suitable for both small-scale and large-scale deployments.

The framework is also known for excellent documentation and a large, active developer community. This means developers can quickly find tutorials, solutions, and extensions for any functionality they want to implement. Flask's compatibility with modern API standards makes it ideal for building backend services that can be consumed by mobile apps, frontend frameworks like React or Angular, or IoT devices.

Overall, Flask's combination of flexibility, simplicity, and powerful extension ecosystem makes it one of the most trusted frameworks for building secure, maintainable, and high-performing web applications across various domains.

Key Points

1. **Lightweight Python Framework:** Flask is a minimalistic and flexible web framework built with Python.
2. **Easy to Learn:** Its simplicity and readable syntax make it suitable for beginners and professionals alike.
3. **Dynamic Web Pages:** Supports dynamic routing, form handling, session management, and URL management.
4. **Templating Engine:** Uses Jinja2 to create dynamic HTML while keeping application logic separate from the UI.
5. **Database Integration:** Works with databases like MySQL, SQLite, and MongoDB for efficient data storage and retrieval.
6. **RESTful API Support:** Enables building APIs for seamless interaction between frontend and backend.
7. **Scalable and Flexible:** Developers can add libraries and tools as needed for project-specific requirements.
8. **Lightweight & Fast:** Low resource consumption leads to faster response times and efficient performance.
9. **Community & Documentation:** Extensive resources, plugins, and support for enhancing functionality and security.
10. **Application in Lost & Found Systems:** Facilitates secure reporting, tracking, and management of lost and found items with a user-friendly interface.
11. **Modular Architecture Support:** Flask allows the use of Blueprints, making it easy to break large applications into smaller, manageable modules.
12. **Built-in Debugger & Development Server:** Comes with an automatic debugger and a development server that help developers test and fix issues faster.
13. **Middleware Support:** Supports custom middleware for tasks like logging, authentication, and request filtering to enhance security and control.
14. **Extensible Through Plugins:** Thousands of extensions exist for features like authentication, form validation, email handling, and encryption.

CHAPTER-2

LITERATURE SURVEY

2.1 EXISTING LOST & FOUND SYSTEMS

In addition to these advancements, existing lost and found systems have increasingly incorporated automated features to improve accuracy and user experience. Many modern platforms integrate notification systems that alert users when an item matching their description is submitted, reducing the time required for item recovery. Some advanced systems also use QR codes or digital tagging to label found items so they can be easily tracked through different stages submission, storage, verification, and handover. This not only reduces confusion but also creates a transparent chain of custody for each item.

Existing systems in public institutions, airports, transportation hubs, and large organizations often emphasize security and accountability. They maintain logs of every action performed on an item, including who submitted it, when it was stored, and who claimed it. This ensures there is minimal room for disputes or fraudulent claims. Some institutions also enforce identity verification or proof-of-ownership checks before releasing items, further strengthening trust in the system.

Another important aspect noted in literature is the integration of analytics and reporting tools. Digital lost and found systems can generate monthly or yearly reports showing the number of items lost, found, matched, and unclaimed. Such data helps administrators understand common problem areas, plan better storage systems, and allocate resources efficiently. For example, campuses can identify frequently lost items like ID cards, phones, or accessories and introduce awareness campaigns or preventive measures.

Existing systems are also increasingly being designed with mobile compatibility, allowing users to submit or search for items through smartphones. This ensures accessibility and encourages more people to report items promptly. However, despite these improvements, many platforms still face challenges related to user adoption, limited image recognition capability, inconsistent data entry, and lack of standardization across institutions. These gaps highlight the need for more intelligent, scalable, and user-cantered lost and found solutions.

Key Points

1. **Traditional Systems:** Manual, paper-based logs or notice boards were used to track lost and found items.
2. **Limitations of Manual Systems:** Slow retrieval, missing or incomplete records, lack of centralization, and inefficiency.
3. **Digital Transition:** Modern institutions use web-based platforms for reporting, storing, and tracking items.
4. **Centralized Database:** Allows efficient storage, search, and management of lost and found items.
5. **User Interaction:** Users can submit item details, upload images, and track item status online.
6. **Admin Management:** Admin panels enable verification, approval, and monitoring of entries.
7. **Real-Time Notifications:** Automatic alerts notify users when a found item matches their lost item.
8. **Advanced Features:** Some systems use image recognition or object-matching algorithms to improve accuracy.
9. **Scalability:** Digital systems can handle high volumes of items in campuses, offices, airports, or public spaces.
10. **Benefits:** Faster item recovery, improved communication, reduced manual work, increased accuracy, and higher user satisfaction.

2.2 DIGITAL PLATFORMS & AUTOMATION IN CAMPUS MANAGEMENT

Technology-driven campus automation has become a crucial component in modern educational institutions, transforming the way administrative and student-related tasks are handled. As institutions grow in size and complexity, traditional manual methods often fail to support the rising demands for speed, accuracy, and coordination. Digital platforms help overcome these limitations by centralizing all essential services into a unified system, enabling smoother workflows and improving overall operational efficiency. These systems not only reduce the dependency on human intervention but also ensure that administrative processes are executed consistently and transparently.

One of the major advantages of campus automation is its ability to integrate multiple functional modules under one platform. For example, attendance monitoring, grade management, fee collection, hostel allocation, timetable generation, communication portals, and library operations can all be managed digitally. This integration minimizes the duplication of data, eliminates inconsistencies, and allows students and staff to access accurate information instantly. Automation also simplifies communication between departments, ensuring that updates, announcements, and records are available to all relevant stakeholders without delays.

In the specific area of lost and found management, digital automation offers significant improvements compared to traditional systems. Manual registers, physical notice boards, and word-of-mouth communication often lead to missing information, misplacement of records, and slow retrieval processes. Digital platforms address these issues by providing structured forms for submitting lost or found items, ensuring that all entries include important details such as item category, description, colour, location, timestamp, and images. This structured documentation greatly increases the chances of accurately matching items and returning them to their rightful owners.

Key Points:

1. **Paperless Environment:** Digital automation reduces the need for physical documents, promoting eco-friendly campus operations.
2. **Faster Retrieval:** Quick search and filter options allow users to find information instantly without manual checking.
3. **Secure Data Storage:** Cloud-based systems ensure safe storage of all records with backups and encryption.
4. **Multi-Module Integration:** Lost & found systems can connect with ID verification, security databases, and student portals.
5. **Scalable Infrastructure:** Platforms can support growing student populations and increasing data without performance issues.
6. **24/7 Accessibility:** Users can report or check item status anytime, even outside office hours.
7. **Reduced Human Error:** Standardized forms and automated processes avoid mistakes caused by manual entries.
8. **Consistent Record-Keeping:** Ensures uniform data entry and avoids duplication or missing information.
9. **Enhanced Communication:** Built-in messaging or notification systems improve communication between students and administrators.
10. **Role-Based Access:** Only authorized staff can modify or approve records, ensuring system security.

CHAPTER-3

REQUIREMENTS AND SPECIFICATION

3.1 HARDWARE CONSTRAINTS

1. **Processor:** ASUS Vivo book PC
2. **RAM:** 16.0 GB
3. **Hard Disk:** 20GB
4. **Display:** VGA Color Monitor

3.2 SOFTWARE CONSTRAINTS

1. **Operating System:** Windows 11
2. **Language:** Python with the help of Flask Frame work
3. **Compiler:** Visual code / Flask
4. **Database Connection:** SQL Alchemy/SQLite

CHAPTER-4

SYSTEM DESIGN & IMPLEMENTATION

4.1 SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE / DATA FLOW

1. User Interface (Frontend):

- **HTML & CSS:** Used to create the structure, layout, and styling of the web pages, such as forms for reporting lost/found items, item lists, search pages, and user dashboards.
- **Interactive Elements:** HTML forms, buttons, and navigation menus allow users to submit details, upload images, and search for items. CSS ensures a visually appealing responsive interface.

2. Backend Logic:

- **Python with Flask Framework:** Handles the core functionality, including user authentication, item submission, data validation, status tracking, and notifications. Flask routes manage requests from the frontend and respond with the appropriate or pages.

3. Database Management:

- **SQLite/MySQL (or similar):** Stores user information, item details, images, timestamps, and logs in a structured manner. This enables secure retrieval, search, and matching of lost and found items.

4. Data Processing:

- **Item Matching:** Python logic compares lost and found entries based on like item name, category, description, location, and uploaded images to identify potential matches.
- **Search Functionality:** Users can query the database using keywords, filters, or categories to locate specific items.

4.2 FUNCTIONS USED

4.2.1 Backend (Flask) Functions

4.2.1.1 Flask(__name__):

- Initializes the main Flask application.
- Creates the core server responsible for handling routes, processing user actions, and returning web pages.

4.2.1.2 @app.route(url, methods=[...]):

- Defines server routes.
- Handles operations like viewing lost items, submitting found reports, user login, and admin actions.

4.2.1.3 request.form.get(fieldname):

- Reads form data sent from HTML pages.
- Used when users upload item details (name, description, category, etc.).

4.2.1.4 request.files.get(file):

- Retrieves uploaded item images from users.
- Used for attaching photos to lost or found item reports.

4.2.1.5 render_template(template.html, data=data):

- Loads HTML files and passes dynamic data (like item lists).
- Used for pages such as *Home*, *Lost Items*, *Found Items*, and *Admin Dashboard*.

4.2.1.6 redirect(url_for('function')):

- Redirects users after actions like login, item submission, or logout.

4.2.1.7 session['user'] = value:

- Stores logged-in user information.
- Maintains a persistent user session across pages.

4.2.1.8 Database Queries (db.execute() or ORM):

- Executes SQL operations like Insert, Update, Delete, Select.
- Used for saving item data, viewing all items, updating status, and generating reports.

4.2.2 Frontend (HTML & CSS) Functions

4.2.2.1 <form action="URL" method="POST">:

- Creates input forms for submitting lost/found item information.
- Sends data to Flask backend for processing.

4.2.2.2 <input> and <textarea> Tags:

- Collect information such as item name, location, date, category, and description.

4.2.2.3 <img src="path">:

- Displays item images uploaded by users.
- Helps users identify their belongings visually.

4.2.2.4 <table> and Layouts:

- Structures pages to display item lists in an organized format.
- Used in lost/found item listing pages.

4.2.2.5 CSS Styling (.card, .container, .btn):

- Improves UI by adding design components like buttons, cards, and layout sections.

4.2.2.6 Responsive CSS (@media queries):

- Ensures the system works smoothly on mobile, tablet, and desktop screens.

4.2.3 Utility Components

4.2.3.1 Image Upload Handling (Flask save()):

- Saves uploaded images into a server directory for display.

4.2.3.2 Database Mapping:

- Stores item details such as:
  - Item ID
  - Category
  - Description
  - Location
  - Date
  - Image path
  - User ID
  - Status

4.2.3.3 Flash Messages (flash(message))

- Displays alerts such as:
  - "Item added successfully"
  - "Login failed"
  - "Record updated"

4.2.3.4 Pagination (Optional):

• Used to divide long lists of items into pages.

• Improves user experience when many items exist.

CHAPTER-5

APPENDIX

5.1.1 Importing Required Modules

```
from flask import Flask, render_template, request, redirect, url_for, session, flash
import os
import sqlite3
```

5.1.2 Initializing Flask Application

```
app = Flask(__name__)
app.secret_key = "your_secret_key"
```

5.1.3 Database Connection Function

```
def get_db():
    conn = sqlite3.connect("lostfound.db")
    conn.row_factory = sqlite3.Row
    return conn
```

5.1.4 Home Page Route

```
@app.route('/')
def home():
  return render_template("index.html")
```

5.1.5 User Login Route

```
@app.route('/login', methods=['GET','POST'])
def login():
    if request.method == 'POST':
        username = request.form.get("username")
        password = request.form.get("password")
        # Validate with database here
        session['user'] = username
        return redirect(url_for("dashboard"))
    return render_template("login.html")
```

5.1.6 Dashboard Route

```
@app.route('/dashboard')
def dashboard():
    if 'user' not in session:
        return redirect(url_for("login"))
    return render_template("dashboard.html")
```

5.1.7 Add Lost Item

```
@app.route('/add_lost', methods=['GET','POST'])
def add_lost():
    if request.method == 'POST':
        item_name = request.form.get("item_name")
        location = request.form.get("location")
        description = request.form.get("description")
        file = request.files.get("image")
        filename = file.filename
        filepath = os.path.join("static/uploads", filename)
        file.save(filepath)
        conn = get_db()
        conn.execute("INSERT INTO lost_items (name,location,description,image)
VALUES (?,?,?,?)",
                    (item_name, location, description, filename))
        conn.commit()
        flash("Lost item submitted successfully!")
        return redirect(url_for("view_lost"))
    return render_template("add_lost.html")
```

5.1.8 View Lost Items

```
@app.route('/lost_items')
def view_lost():
    conn = get_db()
    items = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM lost_items").fetchall()
    return render_template("lost_items.html", items=items)
```

5.1.9 Add Found Item

```
@app.route('/add_found', methods=['GET','POST'])
def add_found():
    if request.method == 'POST':
        item_name = request.form.get("item_name")
        found_by = request.form.get("found_by")
        file = request.files.get("image")
        filename = file.filename
        file.save(os.path.join("static/uploads", filename))
        conn = get_db()
        conn.execute("INSERT INTO found_items (name,found_by,image) VALUES
(?,?,?)",
                     (item_name, found_by, filename))
        conn.commit()
        flash("Found item submitted successfully!")
        return redirect(url_for("view_found"))
    return render_template("add_found.html")
```

5.1.10 View Found Items

```
@app.route('/found_items')
def view_found():
    conn = get_db()
    items = conn.execute("SELECT * FROM found_items").fetchall()
    return render_template("found_items.html", items=items)
```

5.1.11 Generate Reports

```
@app.route('/reports')
def reports():
    conn = get_db()
    lost = conn.execute("SELECT COUNT(*) FROM lost_items").fetchone()[0]
    found = conn.execute("SELECT COUNT(*) FROM found_items").fetchone()[0]
    return render_template("reports.html", lost=lost, found=found)
```

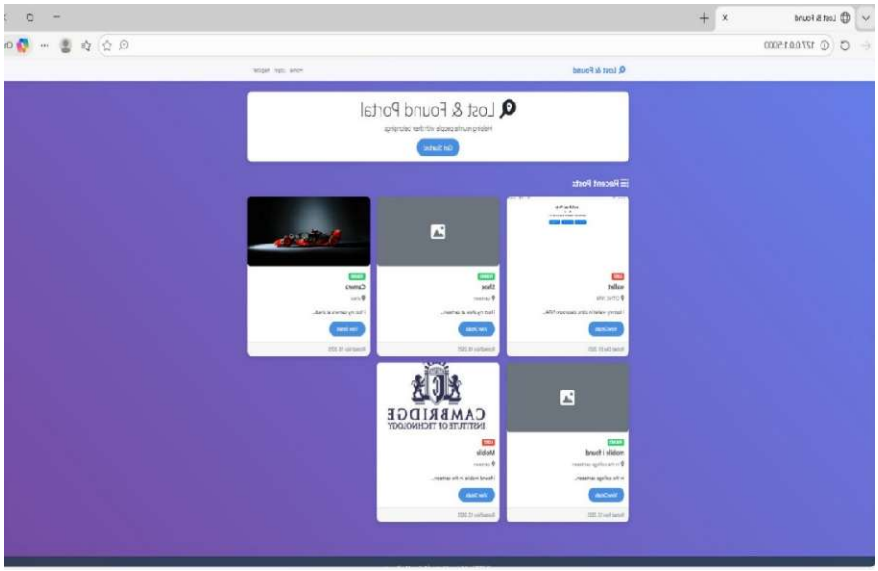
5.1.12 Logout

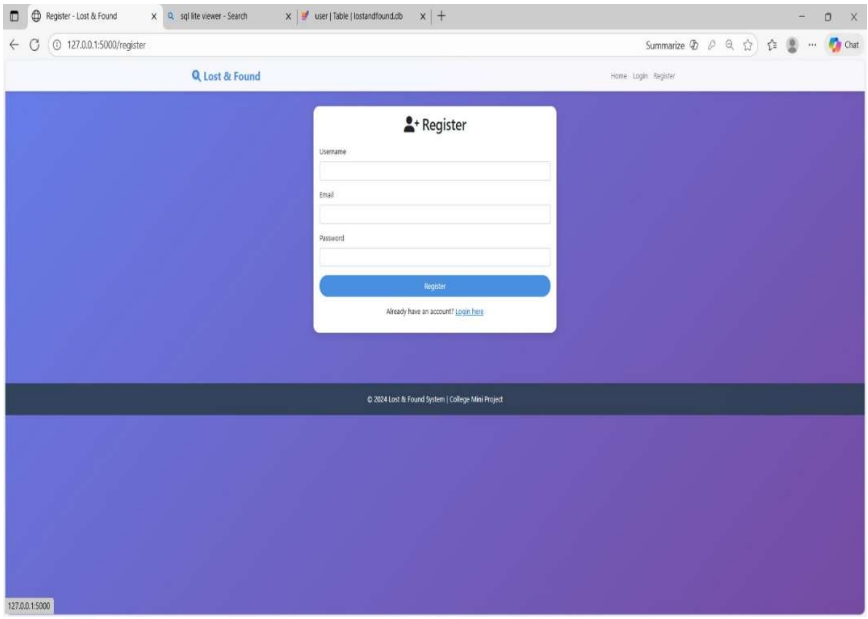
```
@app.route('/logout')
def logout():
    session.pop('user', None)
    return redirect(url_for("home"))
```

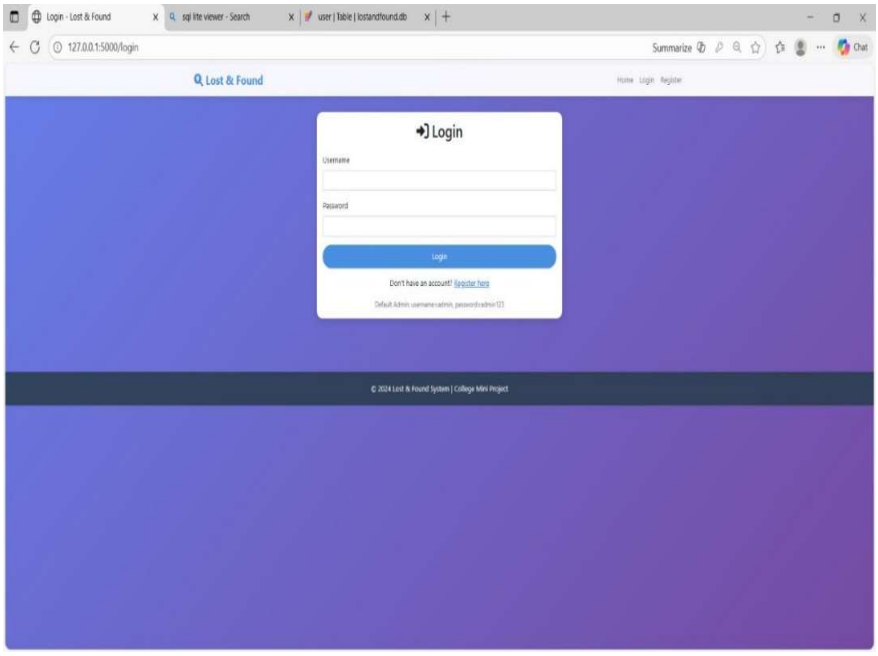
CHAPTER-6

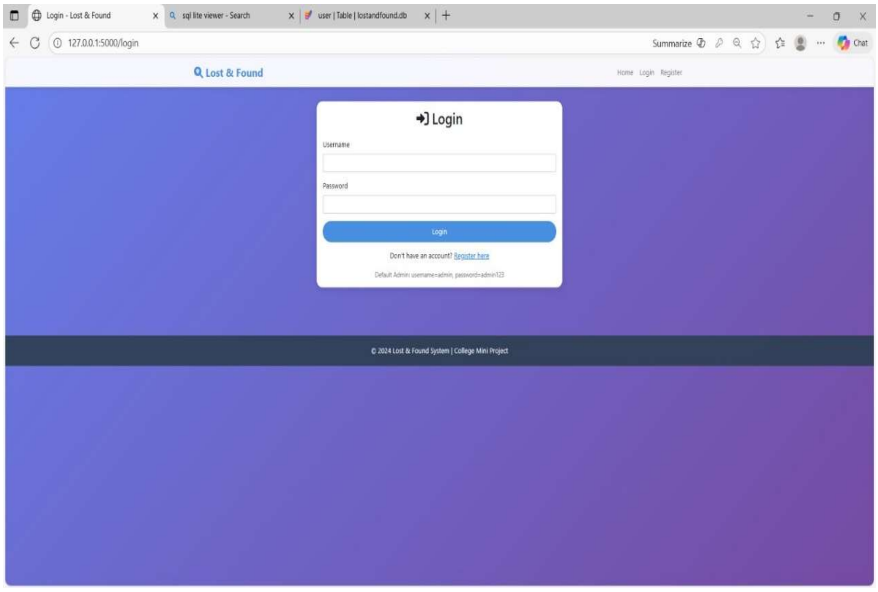
SNAPSHOTS

6.1 SNAPSHOTS






Login - Lost & Found
sql lite viewer - Search
user | Table | lostandfound.db
127.0.0.1:5000/login
Summarize
Chat
Lost & Found
Home Login Register
Login
Username
Password
Login
Don't have an account? Register here
Default Admin: username=admin, password=admin123
© 2024 Lost & Found System | College Mini Project


Login - Lost & Found
sql lite viewer - Search
user | Table | lostandfound.db
127.0.0.1:5000/login
Summarize
Chat
Lost & Found
Home Login Register
Login
Username
Password
Login
Don't have an account? Register here
Default Admin: username=admin, password=admin123
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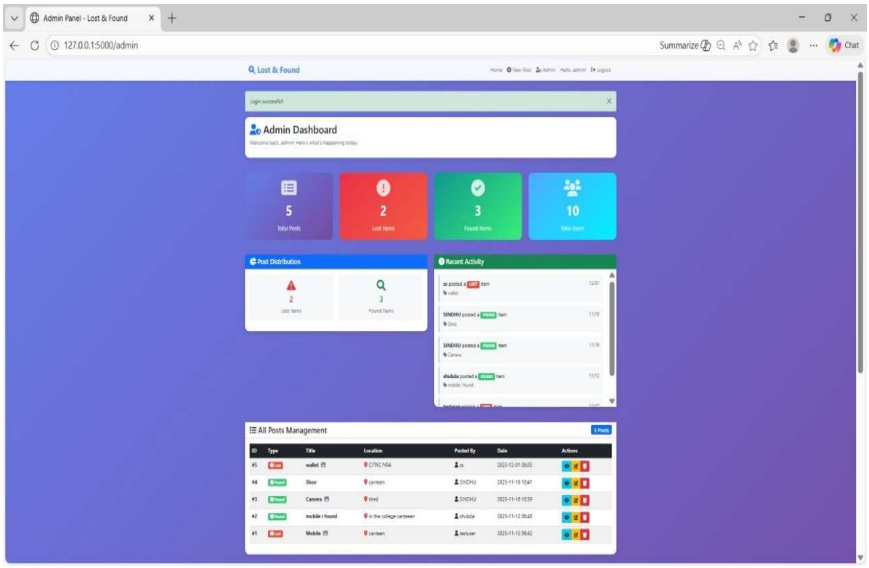
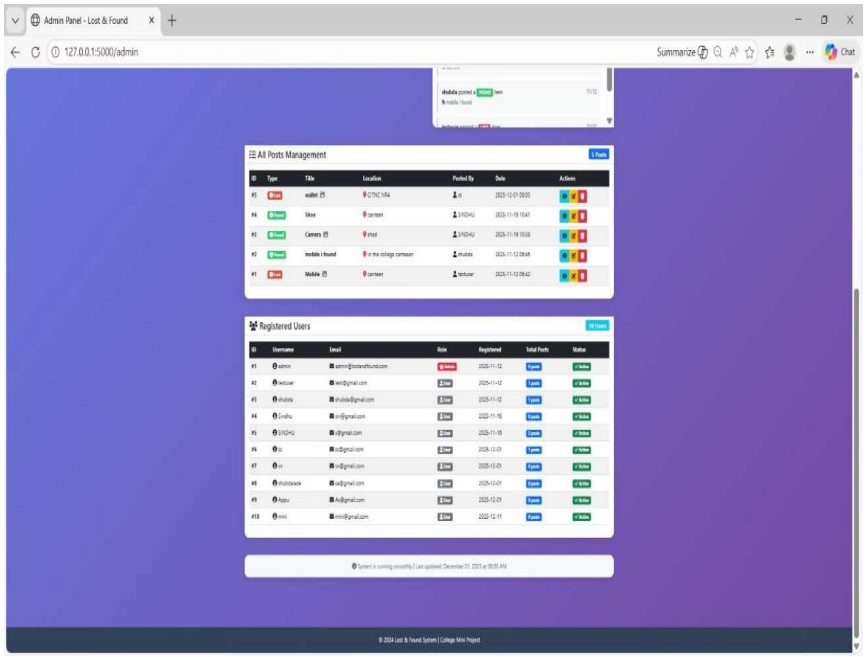
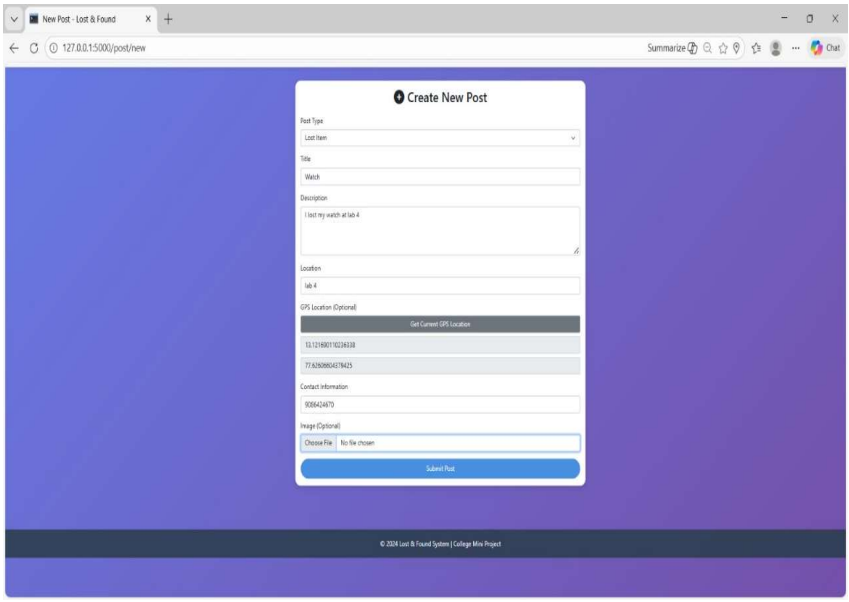
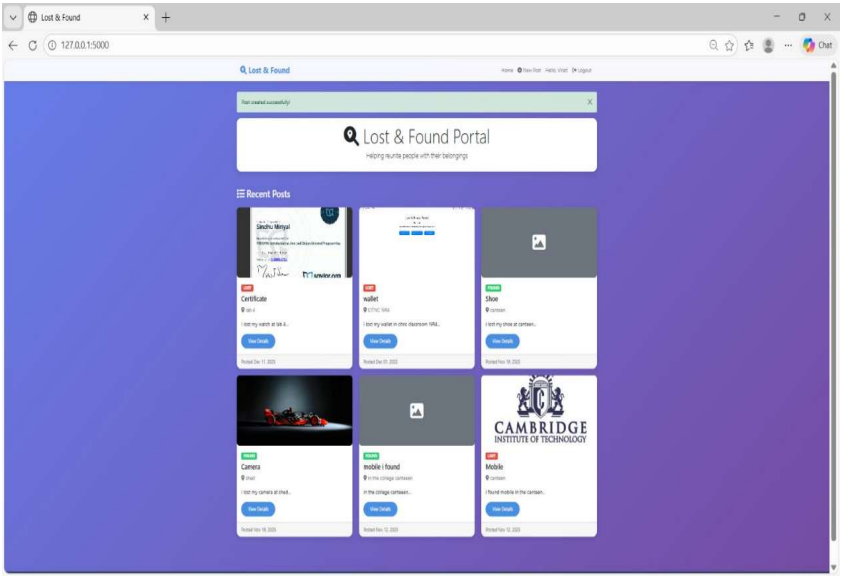

Admin Panel - Lost & Found
127.0.0.1:5000/admin
Lost & Found
Admin Dashboard
5
2
3
10
Post Distribution
Recent Activity
All Posts Management


Admin Panel - Lost & Found
127.0.0.1:5000/admin
All Posts Management
Registered Users


New Post - Lost & Found
127.0.0.1:5000/post/new
Create New Post
Post Type
Lost Item
Title
Watch
Description
I lost my watch at lab 4
Location
lab 4
GPS Location (Optional)
Get Current GPS Location
Contact Information
Image (Optional)
Choose File
No file chosen
Submit Post
© 2024 Lost & Found System | College Mini Project


Lost & Found
127.0.0.1:5000
Lost & Found
Post created successfully!
Lost & Found Portal
Helping reunite people with their belongings
Recent Posts
Certificate
wallet
Shoe
Camera
mobile | found
Mobile
CAMBRIDGE
INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

CONCLUSION

The Lost and Found Platform developed using HTML, CSS for the frontend and Python Flask for the backend serves as a practical demonstration of how modern web technologies can streamline real-world processes. The project effectively bridges user-friendly design with robust server-side functionality, creating a smooth workflow for reporting and recovering lost items.

1. **Seamless Integration of Technologies:**

   The combination of a clean, responsive frontend built with HTML and CSS and a lightweight yet powerful backend implemented in Flask enables a smooth interaction between users and the system. The platform ensures easy navigation, clarity in layout, and efficient data handling, making the overall experience simple and intuitive.

2. **Efficient Item Management:**

   Through Flask routes and database connectivity, users can report lost items or list found belongings with ease. The backend manages user inputs, stores item details securely, and retrieves records quickly whenever needed. This design highlights how Python Flask can be used to build reliable and scalable web applications.

3. **User-Centric Functionality:**

   The platform includes essential features like item categorization, image upload, search functionality, and detailed item descriptions. These features help create a system that genuinely supports users in locating or returning items, demonstrating the practical value of the project.

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